

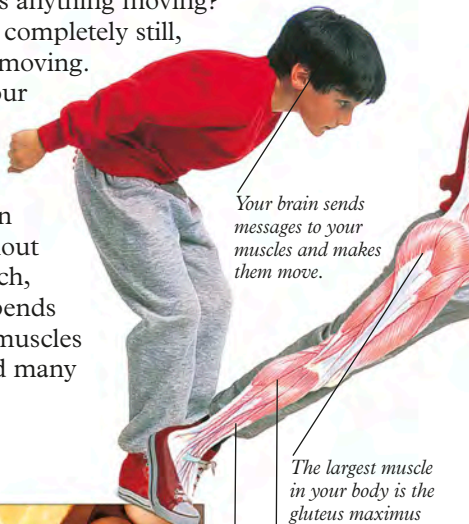


MUSCLES



Try to sit as still as you can. Is anything moving? Even when you think you are completely still, many parts of your body are moving.

Your heart is beating and your intestines and lungs are working. All these movements are made by muscles. You have more than 600 muscles spread throughout your body. Every bend, stretch, twist, and turn you make depends on them. You use about 200 muscles each time you take a step, and many more when you jump.



Your brain sends messages to your muscles and makes them move.

The largest muscle in your body is the gluteus maximus muscle in your thigh and bottom.

If you stand on tiptoe, you can see your calf muscles in the back of your leg.

Muscle food

To keep your muscles working properly you need a diet that includes protein. Foods that are full of protein include meat, eggs, cheese, and dried beans.



Biceps contracts

Triceps relaxes

Up



Biceps relaxes

Triceps contracts

Down

Arm bend

Muscles are attached to bones and make them move. But they can only pull; they cannot push—which is why they always work in pairs. In your arm, the biceps and triceps muscles work together to move it up and down.

When the biceps pulls, or contracts, it gets shorter and fatter and bends the arm.

As the biceps pulls, the triceps muscle relaxes.

Before you begin to make any strenuous movements, you should always warm up your muscles by doing gentle warm-up and stretching exercises.